Sprint 1 Retrospective

Spell Arena Wizard Game

By: Landen Tomlin

What Went Wrong (Individual Level):

- Art direction is harder than I expected.
- My previous code is hard to improve upon.
- Difficulty deciding which method to use for UI tools. (UI toolkit or Canvas)

What Went Well (Individual Level):

- The pinned spells feature works and will be helpful for new players.
- Discussions with Ai about art direction has proven successful and will help me through sprint 2
- I have a clear plan for user testing, custom models, and player rewards

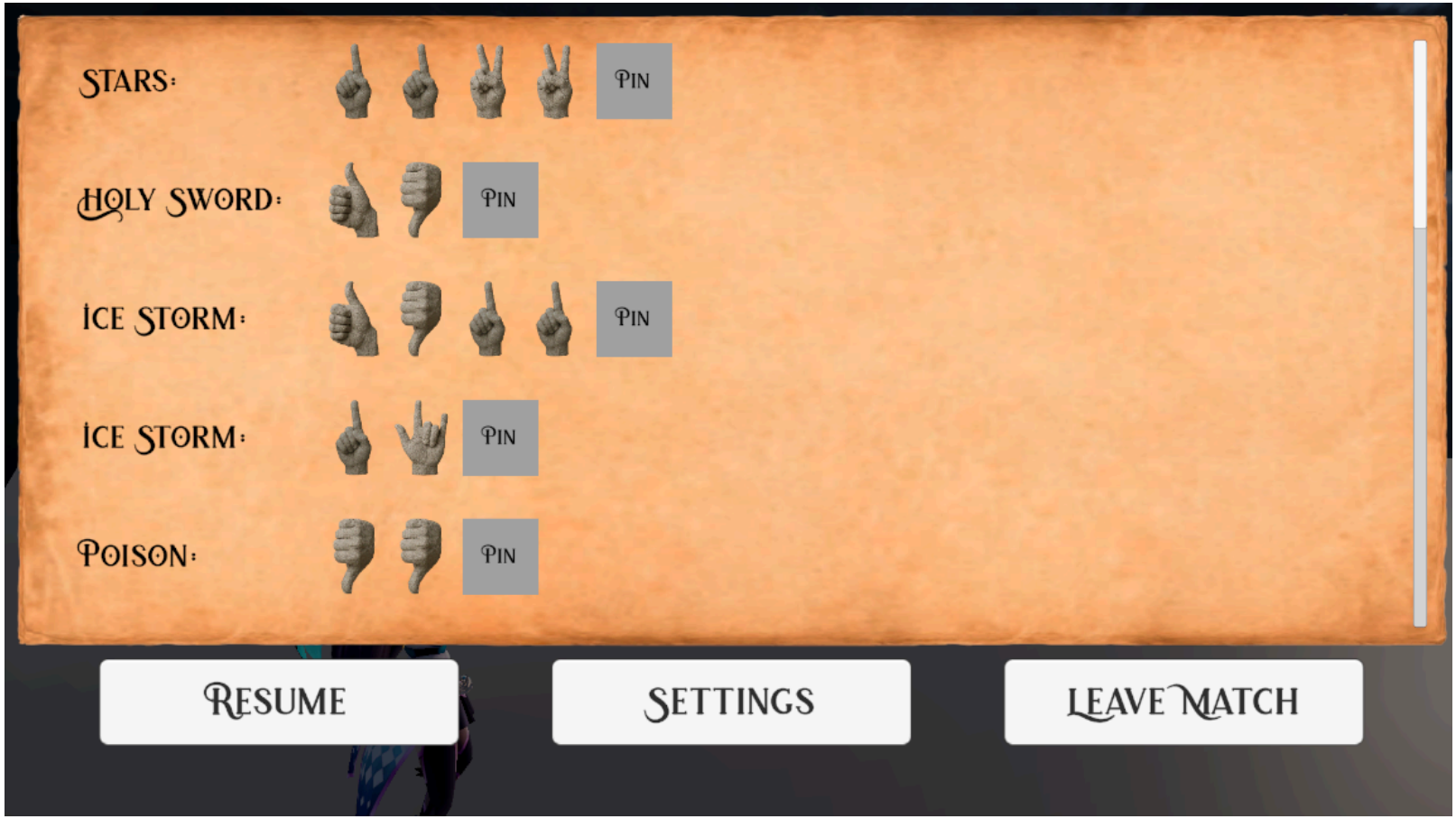
Analysis & Improvement Plan (Individual Level):

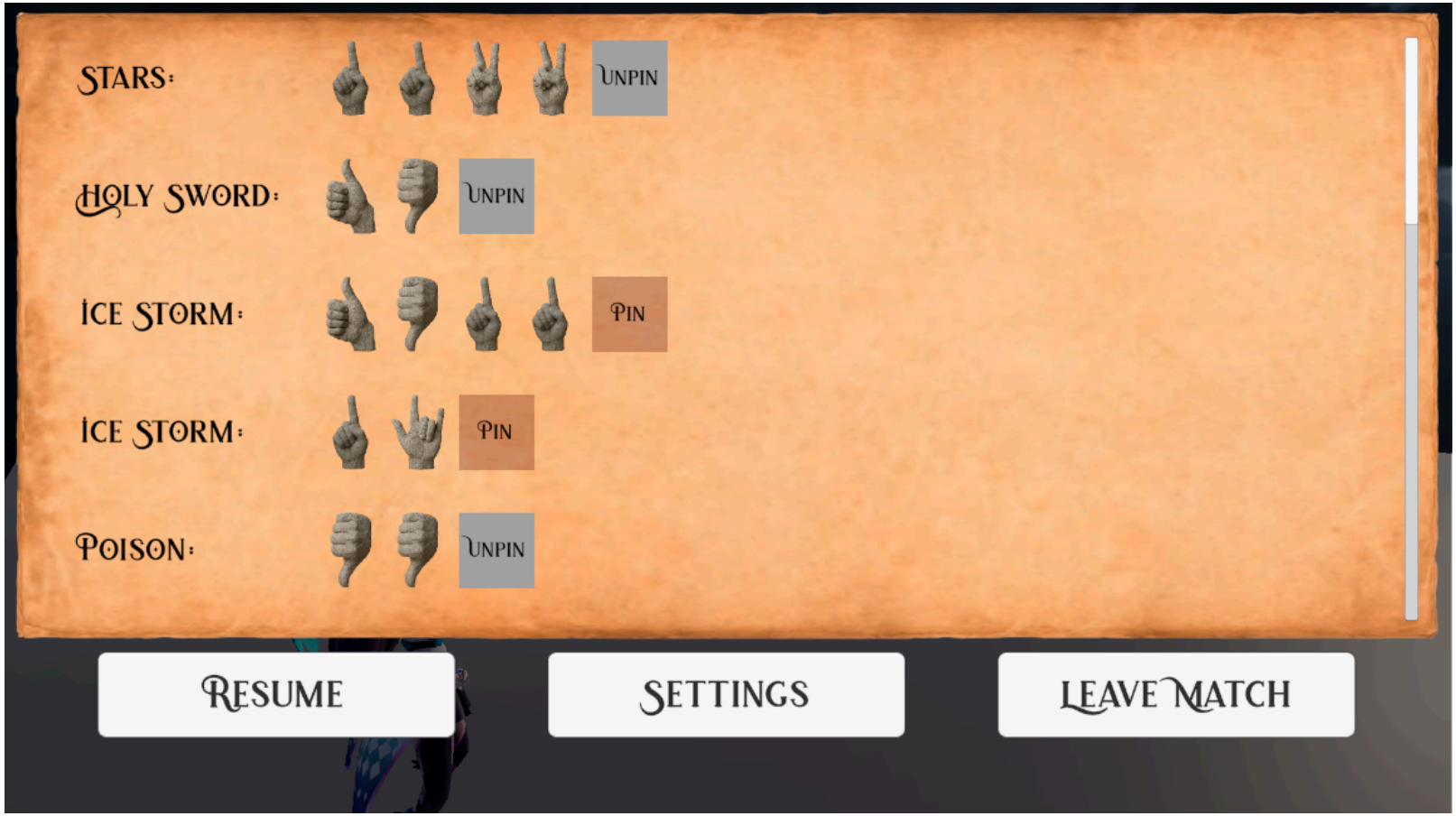
- Be more proactive on working on the project and communicate with Joey and Philip more often
- Look for inspiration from other video games to implement what works well already.

Weekly Progress for Sprint 1

- Week 1: Research and discussion of plans for Sprint 1 with Joey and Philip
- Week 2: Implemented pinned spells features for new players
- Week 3: Set plans to have personal models through connections to the DFX major at NKU. Discussed plans to host user testing during week 2 of Sprint 2
- Week 4: Worked with AI to begin learning about Art Direction and Visual themeing as it relates to our game.

Pinned Spells Showcase




STARS:
UNPIN
HOLY SWORD:
UNPIN
ICE STORM:
PIN
ICE STORM:
PIN
POISON:
UNPIN
RESUME
SETTINGS
LEAVE MATCH

Game: 23.1 FPS
MP Input: 23.9 FPS
Camera: 10.6 FPS
MP Output: 4.8 FPS
HOLY SWORD:
POISON:

Sprint 2 Goal and Metrics

Individual Sprint 2 Goals:

- Import custom models and have options for players to choose from.
- Create the settings page for users to select/deselect assitive features
- Allow users to win items that can be displayed on their character
- Host user testing events

Individual Sprint 2 Metrics:

- Number of team features planned for this sprint: 4
- Number of team requirements planned for this sprint: 10

Updated Individual Timeline and Milestones:

- Week 1: Prepare for user testing by creating handfuls of A/B formats for UI and other features
- Week 2: Schedule and execute public user testing for all completed features
- Week 3: Implement custom models and environments for users to pick from.
- Week 4: Polish UI and prepare for release or showcase.

Learning with AI

Learning Art Direction for Spell Arena

Learning Plan:

1. Study visual identity in games like:
    - League of Legends (color-coded abilities)
    - Wizard 101
2. Use AI to:
    - Generate art direction mood boards
    - Compare stylized vs dark fantasy approaches
    - Analyze visual readability in PvP games

3. Create:
    - Element color system (Fire, Ice, Arcane, Nature)
    - Spell readability rules (0.5 second recognition)
    - UI theme consistency guide

Outcome:

A documented Art Direction Pillar for Spell Arena.

Learning Assistive Features in Games

Goal:

Design Spell Arena to be competitive and accessible.

Research Areas:

- Colorblind modes (Protanopia, Deuteranopia, Tritanopia)
- Adjustable visual intensity
- Remappable controls
- Cognitive clarity in spell descriptions

AI-Assisted Learning:

- Generate accessibility checklists
- Study accessibility practices in competitive games
- Simulate user experience scenarios

Outcome:

An Accessibility Feature Roadmap for Spell Arena.

Questions?